

Keyence (6861.T): We expect robust conditions to continue; reiterate Buy (on CL)

Our view

Based on trends in various industry statistics available as of October 7 and the monthly sales trends of related companies, we have revised our estimates (we raise our FY3/27-30 operating profit estimates by an average of +1% from our previous estimates). For Keyence, given our view that a phase has arrived in which the strength of its business model stands out, we reiterate our Buy rating (on CL).

We believe that the focus at the time of the 1Q results was on whether Keyence could capture the rapidly expanding AI capex. We had assumed that sensor-related companies would be particularly well positioned, but the scale of the benefits actually realized and the extent of the earnings beat were sufficient to prompt a significant upward revision in market consensus. Our market research conducted to date has also reconfirmed that the strength of Keyence's fundamentals is especially pronounced. We expect the favorable business conditions to continue.

Looking ahead to the 2Q results and beyond into 2H, we believe the focus is shifting once again to whether or not supply constraints will emerge. From this perspective, Keyence's track record of maintaining its same-day delivery system should provide the greatest reassurance. We expect 2Q results to again be strong, and we forecast 2Q operating profits of ¥199 bn (OPM of 53.7%).

Valuation

In line with changes in valuation across the Japan machinery sector, we lower the sector EV/EBITDA multiple, based on the median of coverage stocks, to 9X from 10X previously. We also shift the base period for our target price calculation to the midpoint of FY3/28E-FY3/29E from FY3/28E previously. As a result, our 12-month target price remains unchanged at ¥115,000.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Keyence (6861.T)

Our 12-month target price of ¥115,000 is based on the average of FY3/28E and FY3/29E EV/EBITDA, applying the sector-average multiple of 9X and a 170% sector-relative premium.

Key downside risks include (1) disappointment in the company's enhancement towards shareholder returns, (2) a slowdown in capex in tech-related industries, its major client industries, and (3) OPM dropping below 50%, the symbolic standard margin for the company.

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Exhibit 1: Keyence: Earnings summary

Keyence (6861.T) (mn JPY, JPY, %)	3/2023	3/2024	3/2025	3/2026	3/2027GSe	3/2028GSe	3/2029GSe	3/2030GSe	1Q 3/26	2Q 3/26	3Q 3/26	4Q 3/26	1Q 3/27	2Q 3/27
	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	GSE	GSE	GSE	GSE	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	Actual	GSE
Financial data														
Revenues	922,422	967,288	1,059,145	1,169,289	1,509,000	1,643,000	1,817,000	1,954,000	261,076	284,224	289,305	334,684	346,621	370,700
Gross profits	754,732	802,505	887,700	970,737	1,273,000	1,381,000	1,525,000	1,648,000	215,664	235,214	240,535	279,324	294,755	-
Operating profits	498,914	495,014	549,775	595,759	810,000	870,000	950,000	1,020,000	129,301	142,878	144,202	179,378	187,076	199,000
Net profits	362,963	369,642	398,656	445,185	579,000	622,000	679,000	728,000	92,116	107,843	111,208	134,018	139,133	-
EBITDA	510,414	508,814	564,968	612,986	830,000	893,000	977,000	1,050,000	133,101	147,578	147,802	184,578	191,776	-
R&D expenses	21,700	25,200	28,856	32,839	35,000	38,000	41,000	44,000	7,800	8,800	8,200	8,100	8,400	-
(As a % of revenues)	2.4%	2.6%	2.7%	2.8%	2.3%	2.3%	2.3%	2.3%	3.0%	3.1%	2.8%	2.4%	2.4%	-
Depreciation	11,500	13,800	15,193	17,227	20,000	23,000	27,000	30,000	3,800	4,700	3,600	5,200	4,700	-
(As a % of revenues)	1.2%	1.4%	1.4%	1.5%	1.3%	1.4%	1.5%	1.5%	1.5%	1.7%	1.2%	1.6%	1.4%	-
Capital Expenditure	39,300	12,500	14,200	28,371	30,000	30,000	30,000	30,000	7,800	3,800	3,400	13,300	6,100	-
(As a % of revenues)	4.3%	1.3%	1.3%	2.4%	2.0%	1.8%	1.7%	1.5%	3.0%	1.3%	1.2%	4.0%	1.8%	-
As a % of revenues														
Gross profits	81.8%	83.0%	83.8%	83.0%	84.4%	84.1%	83.9%	84.3%	82.6%	82.8%	83.1%	83.5%	85.0%	-
EBITDA	55.3%	52.6%	53.3%	52.4%	55.0%	54.4%	53.8%	53.7%	51.0%	51.9%	51.1%	55.1%	55.3%	-
Operating profits	54.1%	51.2%	51.9%	51.0%	53.7%	53.0%	52.3%	52.2%	49.5%	50.3%	49.8%	53.6%	54.0%	53.7%
Net profits	39.3%	38.2%	37.6%	38.1%	38.4%	37.9%	37.4%	37.3%	35.3%	37.9%	38.4%	40.0%	40.1%	-
Yoy % change														
Revenues	22.1%	4.9%	9.5%	10.4%	29.1%	8.9%	10.6%	7.5%	5.6%	5.9%	11.4%	17.9%	32.8%	30.4%
Gross profits	21.5%	6.3%	10.6%	9.4%	31.1%	8.5%	10.4%	8.1%	4.0%	4.1%	10.7%	17.8%	36.7%	-
EBITDA	19.6%	-0.3%	11.0%	8.5%	35.4%	7.6%	9.4%	7.5%	4.7%	1.9%	7.7%	18.3%	44.1%	-
Operating profits	19.3%	-0.8%	11.1%	8.4%	36.0%	7.4%	9.2%	7.4%	4.8%	1.6%	8.4%	17.4%	44.7%	39.3%
Net profits	19.6%	1.8%	7.8%	11.7%	30.1%	7.4%	9.2%	7.2%	-1.5%	12.1%	9.0%	25.4%	51.0%	-
Operating profit analysis (All GSe)														
	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe	GSe
Change in sales	90,774	12,611	55,202	92,549	233,020	116,838	122,493	109,999	17,921	16,880	21,236	34,356	51,765	54,143
FX change	49,700	26,400	22,400	1,800	44,700	-6,100	13,300	0	-6,300	-3,500	3,600	8,000	18,900	19,305
Change in COGS (Kaizen)	-4,033	11,063	8,986	-9,278	23,386	0	16,430	18,170	-3,348	-4,028	-1,656	-124	8,426	0
Fixed cost (mostly SG&A)	-55,572	-53,974	-31,827	-39,087	-90,795	-51,000	-68,000	-56,000	-2,377	-7,034	-12,046	-15,596	-21,316	-17,665
Others	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total	80,869	-3,900	54,761	45,984	210,311	59,738	84,223	72,169	5,896	2,318	11,134	26,636	57,775	55,783
Sales by destination														
Japan	348,079	344,567	372,752	390,066	476,000	538,000	592,000	621,000	85,900	101,200	88,800	114,800	102,600	121,400
North America/Latin America	191,330	218,780	246,769	282,131	355,000	402,000	456,000	502,000	62,000	67,400	73,400	79,400	81,700	89,000
Asia	251,262	244,378	275,182	319,336	470,000	490,000	540,000	590,000	72,400	75,600	80,800	90,600	114,900	110,200
Europe and others	131,934	152,725	158,580	176,930	208,000	213,000	229,000	241,000	40,800	40,100	46,100	49,900	47,300	50,100
Overseas total	574,343	622,721	686,393	779,223	1,033,000	1,105,000	1,225,000	1,333,000	175,182	183,040	200,488	219,887	244,021	249,316
Total	922,422	967,288	1,059,145	1,169,289	1,509,000	1,643,000	1,817,000	1,954,000	261,076	284,224	289,305	334,684	346,621	370,736
Sales yoy by destination (JPY basis)														
Japan	12.2%	-1.0%	8.2%	4.6%	22.0%	13.0%	10.0%	4.9%	5.2%	3.8%	0.3%	8.6%	19.9%	-
North America/Latin America	40.0%	15.2%	13.2%	13.3%	25.8%	13.2%	13.4%	10.1%	5.8%	7.5%	17.7%	16.4%	31.4%	-
Asia	19.7%	-2.0%	12.7%	16.7%	47.2%	4.3%	10.2%	9.3%	11.5%	10.1%	21.2%	17.5%	50.5%	-
Europe and others	33.7%	18.6%	2.2%	8.4%	17.6%	2.4%	7.5%	5.2%	-4.4%	1.4%	10.1%	18.4%	28.2%	-
Overseas total	29.1%	8.4%	10.2%	13.5%	32.6%	7.0%	10.9%	8.8%	5.8%	7.1%	17.2%	11.5%	39.0%	-
Total	22.1%	4.9%	9.5%	10.4%	29.1%	8.9%	10.6%	7.5%	5.6%	5.9%	11.4%	17.9%	32.8%	-
Sales yoy by destination (LC basis)														
Japan									5.2%	3.8%	0.3%	8.6%	19.9%	20.0%
North America/Latin America									14.2%	13.7%	15.0%	17.5%	18.4%	20.0%
Asia									17.1%	13.5%	18.9%	18.4%	33.9%	30.0%
Europe and others									-2.5%	0.2%	2.2%	11.5%	12.8%	15.0%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

6861.T

12m Price Target: ¥115,000

Price: ¥81,650

Upside: 40.8%

Buy **CL**

GS Forecast

Market cap: ¥19.0tr / \$124.0bn
 Enterprise value:
 ¥18.0tr / \$113.8bn
 3m ADTV: ¥49.3bn / \$309.8mn
 Japan
 Japan Industrials
 M&A Rank: 3
 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥bn)	1,169.3	1,509.0	1,643.0	1,817.0
Op. profit (¥bn) New	595.8	810.0	870.0	950.0
Op. profit (¥bn) Old	595.8	800.0	860.0	940.0
Op. profit CoE (¥bn)	—	—	—	—
EPS (¥) New	1,835.6	2,411.6	2,624.1	2,904.9
EPS (¥) Old	1,835.0	2,382.5	2,594.5	2,874.9
P/E (X)	31.5	33.9	31.1	28.1
P/B (X)	4.0	5.3	5.0	4.8
CHOC1 (%)	23.4	29.8	30.7	32.4
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)	579.5	—	—	—

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 7 Oct 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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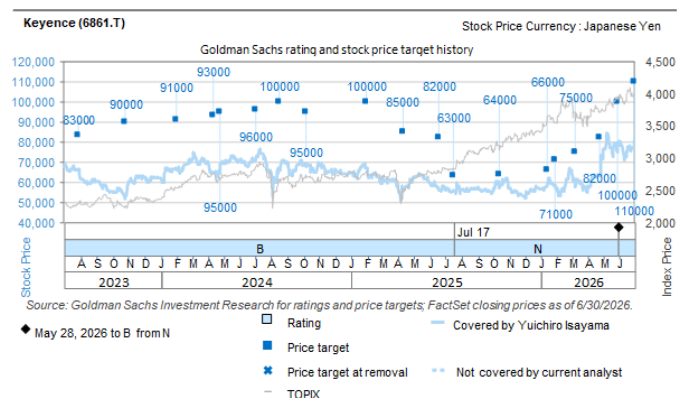
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Target price history table(s)

Keyence (6861.T)

Date of report Target price (¥) Closing price (¥)

29-Jul-26	115,000	77,590
29-Jun-26	110,000	78,200
28-May-26	100,000	75,180
24-Apr-26	82,000	63,180
09-Mar-26	75,000	57,870
29-Jan-26	71,000	58,780
14-Jan-26	66,000	58,830
13-Oct-25	64,000	60,440
17-Jul-25	63,000	55,940
20-Jun-25	82,000	56,180
11-Apr-25	85,000	56,100
31-Jan-25	100,000	67,250
07-Oct-24	95,000	69,400
16-Aug-24	100,000	66,340
02-Jul-24	96,000	71,090
25-Apr-24	95,000	64,580
12-Apr-24	93,000	64,900
02-Feb-24	91,000	66,090
27-Oct-23	90,000	53,050

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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